between Dirang and Senge Dzong; concentrate forces and strike at the five battalions holding Se-la from multiple directions; and attack Dirang Dzong and then push towards Thembang and Bomdila. Chinese commanders were told that lack of roads should not hinder troop movements and they should always make sure to protect their flanks as they marched.

Accordingly, Lieutenant General Zhang Gua Hua, the commander of Tibet Military Region, formulated his operational plans. Reporting back to the CMAC, Hua emphasized four key aspects. First, he would carry out multiple attacks on Indian troops ruthlessly. Second, deploy the forces after a careful study of the terrain. Third, identify the command elements at Dirang Dzong and destroy them so that the entire Indian force would be headless and unable to reinforce Se-la. Fourth, even if Dirang Dzong held out, he would get behind the Indian troops with three regiments to cut off their escape towards the south.

This plan was not without its risks and drawbacks. Since some of the routes that the troops would have to take to outflank the Indian positions were long, developing and maintaining effective supply lines would be difficult. Chinese infantry could carry seven days' dry rations themselves while a Tibetan labour force could establish a base with another three days' dry rations. The most damning aspect of this attack would be the numbers. The Indians were known to have seven battalions deployed in the Dirang and Bomdila area. Getting behind Se-la with 10,800 Chinese troops meant that the ratio of Indian to Chinese troops would be barely 1.5:1 which could prove disastrous for the attacking troops. If they managed to overrun Se-la, then the situation could be salvaged but if it held out for even a week, the Chinese campaign would collapse. The assault on the Indian 62 Brigade at Se-la would be launched using four infantry regiments (equivalent to four Indian brigades), supported by three artillery regiments. This was a ratio of 3:1, which was ideally not enough for an attacking force against well-entrenched troops. Outflanking troops moving along the western side of Se-la would have to take care to stay away from the Bhutan border. Though maintaining supply lines along this axis was expected to be easier, there would be less room to manoeuvre.

The CMAC after deliberation gave the Tibet Frontier Command the go-ahead and deployed 419 Tibetan Unit (Division), 11 Division (32 and 33 Regiments), 55 Division (154, 155, 157, 163 and 165 Regiments), the Shan Naan Army with four companies, Artillery (306, 308 and 504 Regiments),